Nejla Asimovic

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS AND AFFILIATIONS

Georgetown University, McCourt School of Public Policy — Washington, D.C.
Assistant Professor — *August 2024 - Present*

Cornell University
Non-Resident Fellow, Center on Global Democracy — *January 2026-Present*

New York University
Research Affiliate, Center for Social Media and Politics — *September 2018 - Present*

University of Pennsylvania
Postdoctoral Fellow, Institute for the Study of Citizens and Politics — *July 2023 - July 2024*

EDUCATION

New York University — New York, NY
Ph.D. in Political Science — *2023*
Committee: Joshua Tucker, Gwyneth McClendon, Shanker Satyanath, and Cyrus Samii

Hamilton College — Clinton, NY
Bachelor of Arts (Summa Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa) — *2016*
Major: World Politics; Minors: Mathematics and Hispanic Studies

PEER REVIEWED ARTICLES

Steven Rathje*, **Nejla Asimovic***, Tiago Ventura*, Sarah Mughal, Claire E. Robertson, Christopher Barrie, Joshua Tucker, and Jay J. Van Bavel. "Testing the Causal Impact of Social Media Reduction Around the Globe." (Accepted in Principle, *Nature*, 2025) *[co-first author; pre-registered report]

Asimovic, Nejla, Mateo Vásquez-Cortés, and Kevin Munger. "Bridging the Digital Divide: Data Access and Integration of Venezuelan Migrants in Colombia." (Conditionally Accepted, *Quarterly Journal of Political Science*, 2026)

Asimovic, Nejla. "Unlocking Outgroup Access Online: Evidence From Cyprus." *Comparative Political Studies* (2026)

Macdonald, Maggie, Megan A. Brown, **Nejla Asimovic**, Rajeshwari Majumdar, Lena Song, Laura Huber, Sarah Graham, Joshua A. Tucker, and Jonathan Nagler. "Reaching Across the Political Aisle: Overcoming Challenges in Using Social Media for Recruiting Politically Diverse Respondents." *International Journal of Social Research Methodology* (2026)

Asimovic, Nejla, and Ruth Ditlmann. "Cross-Group Friends and Feeling Empowered in Intergroup Contact Programs: Mediating Pathways and Practical Strategies for Divided Societies." *Journal of Social and Political Psychology* (2026)

Asimovic, Nejla, Ruth Ditlmann, and Cyrus Samii. "Estimating the effect of intergroup contact over years: Evidence from a youth program in Israel." *Political Science Research and Methods*, 1–19 (2024)

Asimovic, Nejla*, Jonathan Nagler, and Joshua A. Tucker. "Replicating the effects of Facebook deactivation in an ethnically polarized setting." *Research and Politics*, 10, no. 4 (2023) *[first author]

Asimovic, Nejla*, Jonathan Nagler, Richard Bonneau, and Joshua A. Tucker. "Testing the effects of Facebook usage in an ethnically polarized setting." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 118, no. 25 (2021). *[first author]

- ◇ Best Article Award by the Information Technology & Politics section at APSA 2022; coverage from the New Yorker, Tech Policy Press

ELEMENT

Asimovic, Nejla. *Experiments on Social Media Usage Effects and Intergroup Relations*, Cambridge University Press, Elements in Experimental Political Science (Under Contract)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Asimovic, Nejla and Mateo Vásquez-Cortés. "Elevating Positive Narratives: WhatsApp Campaign Effects on Migrant-Host Relations in Colombia." *(Completed data collection)*

Asimovic, Nejla, Samantha Moore-Berg, Mikelle Barberi-Weil. "Workplace Readiness in Polarized Settings: Unify America Program Evaluation." *(Completed data collection)*

Asimovic, Nejla. "Digital Discourse and Polarization: Spotlighting Diversity Within and Across Groups in the United States." *(Preregistration available)*

Asimovic, Nejla and Diana Mutz. "Do Elections Reduce American Social Trust?" (*Working paper*)

GRANTS AND AWARDS

2025: Georgetown University Global Engagement Faculty Collaborative Grant (with Laia Balcells and Ruth Ditlmann)
2025: Georgetown University Research Leave (GURL), Office of the Provost
2025: Institute for Humane Studies Research Award ($5,000$) with Samantha Moore-Berg and Mikelle Barberi-Weil
2024: Institute for Humane Studies Research Award ($10,000$)
2024: National Science Foundation: "Secure and Trustworthy Cyberspace" with Jay Van Bavel, Joshua Tucker, Steven Rathje, and Claire Robertson ($1,199,751$)
2024: Tech & Public Policy Grant, McCourt School of Public Policy & Project Liberty ($199,026$)
2023: Wellspring Philanthropic Fund ($72,000$) with Mateo Vásquez-Cortés and Kevin Munger
2023: London School of Economics Research Award ($7,400$) with Florian Foos, Marnie Howlett, and Carl Muller-Crepon
2023: Templeton World Charity Foundation ($250,000$) and NYU Alliance Seed Grant ($25,000$) with Jay Van Bavel, Joshua Tucker, Steven Rathje, and Claire Robertson
2022: Meta Research PhD Fellowship
2022: Peace & Recovery Program Grant from the Innovations for Poverty Action ($40,000$) with Mateo Vásquez-Cortés and Kevin Munger
2021: Downs Prize Award ($4,000$), New York University
2021: Peace Scholar Fellowship ($16,200$), Minerva Research Initiative-United States Institute of Peace
2020: Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant ($13,800$), National Science Foundation & American Political Science Association

NON-PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Asimovic, Nejla and Jane Esberg. "Social media data in conflict research." *Institute for Research on the Information Environment* (2022).

Asimovic, Nejla and Amie Scheerder. "Navigating the media landscape in the 21st century: The role of critical media literacy in Bosnia and Herzegovina." *The Centre for Sustainable Peace and Democratic Development* (2022).

SELECTED AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

2025: Georgetown University junior nominee for the 2026 Carnegie Fellowship
2024: Institute for Humane Studies Research Award
2023: Outstanding Teaching Award, New York University College of Arts and Science
2023: Internet Observatory Fellowship, Stanford University (declined)
2023: Center for the Study of Democratic Politics Fellowship, Princeton University (declined)
2022: PhD Research Fellowship, Human-Computer Interaction at Meta
2022: Information Technology & Politics Best Article Prize, American Political Science Association
2022: Dean's Dissertation Fellowship, New York University
2021: Global Research Initiatives Fellowship, New York University
2017-2023: Henry M. MacCracken Fellowship, New York University
2016: Pi Sigma Alpha (National Political Science Honor Society), Hamilton College
2016: Phi Sigma Iota (International Foreign Language Honor Society), Hamilton College
2016: Constantine Karamanlis Prize in World Politics, Hamilton College

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

2025: Technical University of Munich-Georgetown University Workshop on Social Media (Munich, Germany); European Political Science Association Annual Meeting (paper accepted); Intergroup Interventions Workshop (Berlin, Germany; by invite); American Political Science Association Annual Meeting

2024: American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, CIND (Center for Information Networks and Democracy) Political and Information Networks Conference (by invite); Political Psychology Meeting (by invite); Media Effects Empirical Workshop (by invite); Midwest Political Science Association Conference; Visions in Methodology Conference; NYU Center for Social Media and Politics Conference (by invite)

2023: University of Pennsylvania Comparative Politics Workshop; American Political Science Association Annual Meeting; Meta Computational Social Science Seminar; London School of Economics Behavioural Political Economy Workshop; Center for Social Media and Politics Annual Conference; Midwest Political Science Association; WZB Berlin Social Science Center Brown Bag Series

2022: Northeast Regional Workshop on European Politics; Minority Politics Online Seminar Series; American Political Science Association Annual Meeting; Northeast Workshop in Empirical Political Science; Midwest Political Science Association Conference; Carlos III University of Madrid (UC3M) Work in Progress Seminar; NYU Comparative Politics Workshop

2021: American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting; Annual Scientific Meeting of Political Psychology; CSMaP Annual Conference; Midwest Political Science Association Conference (Forthcoming); NYU-CESS Experimental Political Science Conference; Comparative Working Group at the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill; NYU Graduate Student Political Economy Seminar

2020: CSMaP Panel on Social Media, Polarization, and the 2020 Election; Annual Scientific Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology; Midwest Political Science Association Conference; NYU-CESS Experimental Political Science Conference; Intergroup Relations Working Group

TEACHING

Text as Data: Computational Linguistics — Spring 2025
Instructor — *McCourt School of Public Policy*

Social Media and Political Behavior — Spring 2025
Instructor — *McCourt School of Public Policy*

International Relations Thesis Seminar — 2019–2023
Teaching Assistant; two semesters — *New York University*

Introduction to Comparative Politics — 2019–2023
Teaching Assistant; three semesters — *New York University*

OTHER PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Research Consultant — 2021-2024
PeacePlayers International

Reviewer — 2019-Present
Political Science Research and Methods, Journal of Politics, Nature Communications, Political Behavior, Journal of Information Technology & Politics, World Development, Journal of Quantitative Description

WORK EXPERIENCE

Leaders' Quest — 2016-2017
Leadership Program Development — *New York, NY*

The Enough Project — 2015
Development and Operations — *Washington, D.C.*

Doctors of the World — 2014
Administration and Data Entry — *Madrid, Spain*

RELEVANT SKILLS

Languages: Bosnian (native), Serbo-Croatian; English (fluent); Spanish (intermediate)